

Jim Kent

Product Designer (UX / UI)

Seattle, WA | 206-854-8470 | j.laytonkent@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/jim-kent](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jim-kent) | [Portfolio](#)

Product designer with 3+ years designing B2B and B2C digital products end-to-end, from user research and information architecture through high-fidelity UI, design systems, and developer handoff. Background in performing arts and hospitality brings a rare strength in collaboration, stakeholder communication, and human-centered thinking. Known for turning complex, technical problems into accessible, WCAG-compliant experiences that drive measurable clarity and usability.

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer · [Combinely](#)

Feb 2024 - Present

Remote contract · B2B CRM for accountants (team of 5)

- Led the desktop redesign across **five core user flows**, translating usability findings into a modern, accessible UI adopted as the team's chosen design direction.
- Ran competitive analysis, heuristic evaluations, and WCAG-compliant color research that surfaced key accessibility gaps and shaped the redesign strategy.
- Presented multiple UI iterations to stakeholders, incorporating client feedback to validate needs and align design decisions across every screen.
- Delivered a standards-compliant style guide and design system, high-fidelity screens, and complete developer handoff with layout, behavior, and component specifications.
- Took initiative to design an unscoped **AI-assisted reply feature** end-to-end, expanding the product vision beyond the original brief.

Product Designer · [Queryit](#)

Feb 2023 - Feb 2024

Remote contract · B2B AI data-analytics platform (team of 5)

- Designed UI and visual direction for an AI-powered analytics platform, making SQL-level data querying accessible to **non-technical users** through plain-language prompts.
- Collaborated with a team of five to set goals, build a design system, and maintain UI consistency aligned to client brand and preferences.
- Conducted competitive analysis and heuristic evaluation to document design deficiencies, reducing user error and friction across the primary flows.
- Designed low- to high-fidelity wireframes for the platform's most vital flows and introduced save/export features that improved engagement.
- Iterated on feedback from QA and design leads to streamline the interface, and documented full developer handoff with branding and measurement specifications.

Contemporary Dance Artist · [Whim W'Him Seattle Contemporary Dance](#)

2011 - 2023

12 seasons · ~35 weeks/year

- Collaborated with **30+ choreographers and stakeholders** across 12 seasons, interpreting and embodying diverse creative visions under tight timelines.
- Demonstrated exceptional listening, adaptability, and iterative feedback skills that translate directly to cross-functional design collaboration.
- Led warm-up sessions and injury-prevention practices for a seven-member company, creatively problem-solving to meet varied performance demands.

Server & Event Facilitator · [The Corson Building & Sitka & Spruce](#)

2010 - 2023

Hospitality · James Beard Award-winning restaurants

- Delivered empathetic, detail-driven service across 15+ years in hospitality, coordinating **100+ weddings and events** to flawless, timeline-critical execution.
- Contributed to opening-team workflow systems and floor-mapping strategies that optimized service efficiency and elevated guest experience.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Dance Performance & Choreography

Cornish College of the Arts

UX / UI Design Foundations

Designlab · Avocademy

TOOLS

Figma, FigJam, Miro, Notion, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace

SKILLS

Research: Heuristic evaluation, user interviews & script writing, user stories, contextual inquiry, persona development, user flows, moderated usability testing, qualitative & quantitative analysis.

Design: Visual & UI design, wireframing, prototyping, motion design, information architecture, brand design, design systems, component libraries, iteration, icon design, developer handoff, accessibility (WCAG).

Collaboration: Cross-functional teamwork, stakeholder communication, project management, critical thinking, giving & applying feedback, agile process.